



CLEARCODE
READING

Comprehension Strategy Pack

Grades K-2

Comprehension Strategy Pack (K-2)

What are comprehension strategies?

Strong readers construct mental maps as they read, which helps them understand the text. Strong readers know that texts in the same genre can have similar structures. These structural characteristics serve as landmarks on their mental map. For example, when reading a story, a strong reader knows that fiction texts have characters that encounter a problem. The character makes attempts to solve the problem. At the end, they usually solve the problem and learn a lesson. Because they have these landmarks already on their mental map, they are able to keep track of the most relevant details in the text and piece those details together to make meaning. This mental map metaphor extends to informational texts as well. Informational texts have a variety of structures: chronological, sequence, description, compare and contrast, cause and effect, and problem/solution. When your child understands how the author organized the information in the text, they can more easily identify the most relevant details and distill the main idea.

How do comprehension strategies work?

The comprehension strategies included in this pack are designed to help your child construct a mental map as they read. So, while you're reading with your child, make understanding the focus instead of sounding out the words or reading fluently. These skills can take up a lot of mental energy, and make comprehension harder. Your child does not have to read the text on their own in order to practice comprehension. You can read aloud to them, take turns reading, or read side-by-side. If your child is reading aloud to you and comes across a word they do not know, help them sound it out or tell it to them.

One way you can support your child in constructing a clear mental map is by making visible what strong readers notice and think about as they read. Here's how it works:

1. Pick a book your child is interested in reading.
2. Introduce one strategy at a time. Explain what the strategy is, the focus question, and the steps.
3. Take turns reading a section of the book. You can alternate reading sentences, paragraphs, or pages.
4. Pause and show them how you would use the strategy.
5. Continue reading and pausing to use the strategy until your child feels comfortable with the strategy.

What comprehension strategies are included in this pack?

Your child only needs one or two strategies for each type of text to build a clear mental map. There are two strategies for fiction texts and two for informational texts in this pack. Start with the first strategy listed.

Fiction	Informational
• CSPS: Character, Setting, Problem, Solution • FAST: Feelings, Actions, Sayings, Thoughts	• 5Ws+H: Who? What? When? Where? Why? How? • Ask a W or H question about the title

CSPS: Character, Setting, Problem, Solution

Introduce the strategy: *Show your child the picture cards as you introduce the CSPS strategy.*

- All stories have four things in common. We can remember them with the acronym: CSPS.
 - **Character**, or a person, animal, or creature in the story.
 - **Setting**, or the time and place where the story happens.
 - **Problem**, or something that goes wrong, a conflict, or a challenge the character faces.
 - **Solution**, or how the problem works out.

Focus Question: After you read a story, ask: What happened in the story?

Steps:

1. Read part of the story.
2. Pause and ask if you learned any new CSPS details. *Use the picture cards as you ask each question.*
 - **Character:** What did we learn about the character? What do they want?
 - **Setting:** Where and when does the story take place?
 - **Problem:** What problem or challenge did the character face?
 - **Solution:** How does the character try to solve the problem? Did it work?
3. Go back and reread if you missed one of these details.
4. Continue to read, pause, and ask until you finish the story. *This can occur over multiple sessions.*
5. Retell the story using the CSPS details. *Use the picture cards as needed.*

FAST: Feelings, Actions, Sayings, Thoughts

Introduce the strategy: *Show your child the picture cards as you introduce the FAST strategy.*

- Authors use details to show and tell us what qualities a character has – if they are kind or mean, trustworthy or dishonest. We can remember these important details with the acronym: FAST.
 - **Feelings**, a character's emotions about a situation or another character
 - **Actions**, a character's behaviors in a situation
 - **Sayings**, or what a character says out loud to other characters
 - **Thoughts**, or what a character thinks in their head

Focus Question: After you read a story, ask: How did the character respond when there was a problem?

Steps:

1. Read part of the story.
2. Pause and ask if you learned any new FAST details. *Use the picture cards as you ask each question.*
 - **Feelings:** How does the character feel in this moment?
 - **Actions:** What did the character do?
 - **Sayings:** What did the character say?
 - **Thoughts:** What is the character thinking in this moment?
3. Go back and reread if you missed one of these details.
4. Continue to read, pause, and ask until you finish the story. *This can occur over multiple sessions.*
5. Describe how the character responded to a problem using FAST details. *Use the picture cards as needed.*

5Ws+H: Who? What? When? Where? Why? How?

Introduce the strategy: *Show your child the picture cards as you introduce the 5Ws+H strategy.*

- Authors use details to show and tell us about a topic. We can identify these important details by asking W and H questions as we read. We can remember these questions as 5Ws+H.
 - **Who** is the author telling us about?
 - **What** is the author telling us about?
 - **When** did these events happen?
 - **Where** did these events happen?
 - **Why** did this happen?
 - **How** did this happen? Or **How** are these things related?

Focus Questions: After you read a story, ask: What is the text about? What does the author want me to learn about this topic?

Steps:

1. Read a section of the text.
2. Pause and ask if you can answer any W or H questions. *Use the picture cards as you ask each question.*
 - **Who** is...?
 - **What** is...?
 - **When** did...?
 - **Where** did...?
 - **Why** did ...?
 - **How** did ...? Or **How** are ____ and ____ related?
3. Go back and find where the answer is in the text.
4. Continue to read, pause, and ask until you finish the text. *This can occur over multiple sessions.*
5. Explain what the text was about using the details from the text. *Use the picture cards as needed.*

Ask a W or H question about the title

Introduce the strategy:

- Authors give readers a clue about the main idea in the title of informational texts. Use the title to create a W or H question. The key details that answer the question will help you understand the main idea.
 - For example, if the title of our text is *From Seed to Plant*, a Why question might be, "Why do plants have seeds?" A How question might be, "How do seeds become plants?"

Focus Questions: After you read a story, ask: What is the text about? What does the author want me to learn about this topic?

Steps:

1. Read a section of the text.
2. Pause and ask if you can answer your W or H question.
3. Go back and find where the answer is in the text.
4. Continue to read, pause, and ask until you finish the text. *This can occur over multiple sessions.*
5. Explain what the text was about using the details from the text.

CSPS: Character, Setting, Problem, Solution

Picture cards | Cut along the dotted lines.

C S P S

Character



What did we learn about the character?

What do they want?

C S P S

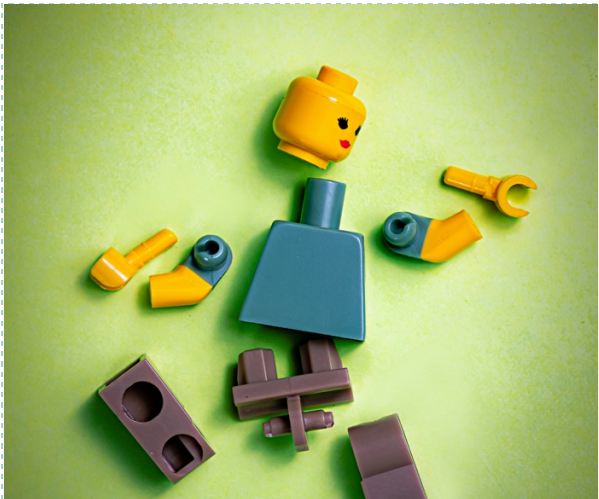
Setting



Where and when does the story take place?

C S P S

Problem



What problem or challenge did the character face?

C S P S

Solution



How does the character try to solve the problem?

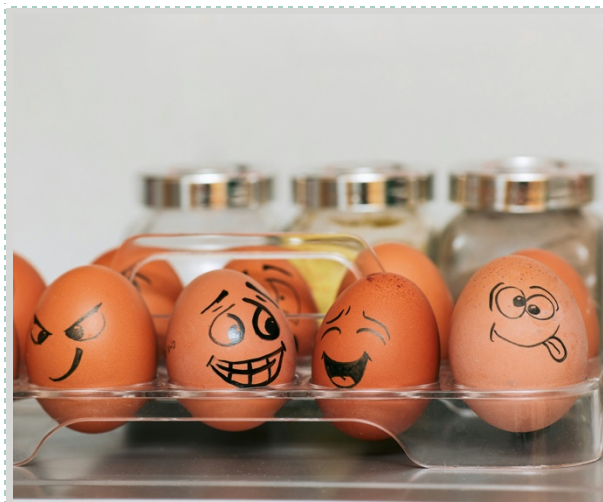
Did it work?

FAST: Feelings, Actions, Sayings, Thoughts

Picture cards | Cut along the dotted lines.

FAST

Feelings



How does the character feel in this moment?

FAST

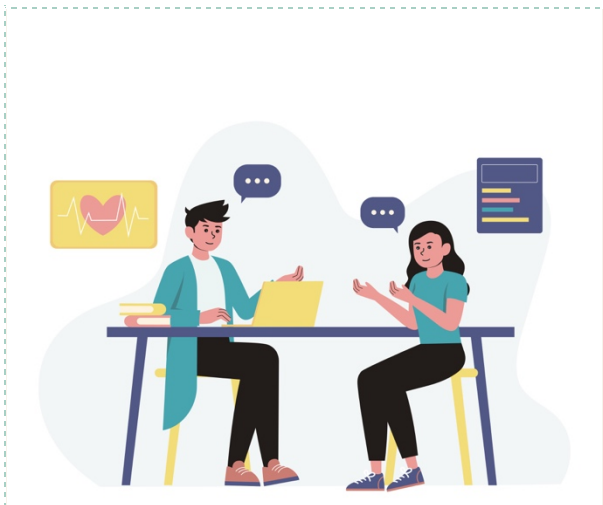
Actions



What did the character do?

FAST

Sayings



What did the character say?

FAST

Thoughts



What is the character thinking in this moment?

5Ws + H: Who, What, When, Where, Why, How

Picture cards | Cut along the dotted lines.

5WS+H

Who



Who is...?

5WS+H

What



What is...?

5WS+H

When



When did...?

5WS+H

Where



Where did...?

5WS+H

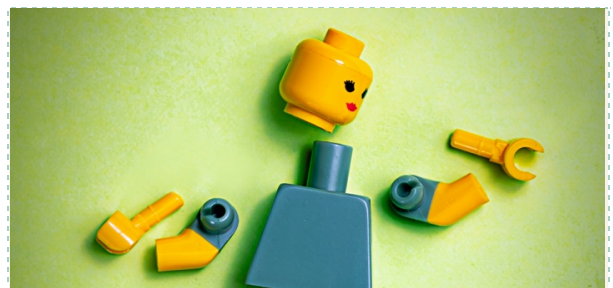
Why



Why did...?

5WS+H

How



How did...?

Or: How are ____ and ____ related?